

The Universal Refuge Protocol

A Framework for Safe Passage, Compassionate Welcome, and Dignified Integration

Preamble

In accordance with the supreme laws of our society, as established in *Powhatan's Hierarchical Codex of Universal Rights* and the *Hierarchical Codex of Collective Responsibility*, this protocol enacts the sacred **Right to Safe Passage & Refuge** (Codex of Rights, Tier 2.6) and fulfills the corresponding **Duty to Provide Safe Passage & Refuge** (Codex of Responsibility, Tier 2.6).

This protocol is the primary instrument by which the Concord of Guilds and its member communities shall welcome any individual seeking sanctuary (hereafter "the Seeker"). It is a process grounded in the virtues of Hospitality (Norse), Compassion (Buddhist), and Benevolence (Bushido), and is designed to ensure the safety, dignity, and well-being of both the Seeker and the host community. Our goal is not merely to provide shelter, but to offer a clear and supportive path toward healing, contribution, and potential membership within our society, in alignment with the principles of the Love Standard and the Acorn Economy.

Phase 1: Initial Contact & Compassionate Reception

Objective: To meet the Seeker's immediate survival needs and ensure the safety and security of all parties, as administered by the designated Guilds.

Step 1: The Designated Welcome

- **Lead Guild:** The **Hearth & Hospitality Guild** is responsible for the initial welcome. They shall designate a small, trained team of "Welcomers" (at least two at a time) known for their level-headedness and compassion.
- **Location:** The first point of contact will be a pre-established safe, neutral, and semi-private space at the community's edge, such as a designated welcome yurt or reception room managed by the Innkeepers' & Chefs' Guild.

Step 2: Immediate Needs Assessment (The Rule of Three)

The Welcomers' first priority is to assess and provide for the Seeker's immediate survival needs without intrusive questioning, in fulfillment of the Duty to Preserve Life (Codex of Responsibility, Tier 1).

- **Water & Food:** Offer clean water and a warm, simple meal immediately.
- **Shelter & Warmth:** Provide a safe, private, and warm place for the Seeker to rest for at least 24 hours.

- **Medical Assessment:** A member of the **Medical Guilds** (Caduceus Covenant or Verdant Mortar) will be on call to assess for urgent medical needs and provide immediate first aid or care as required, upholding the Right to Comprehensive Health (Codex of Rights, Tier 4.3).

Step 3: The Assurance of Safety

The Welcomers will clearly state the following to the Seeker:

"You are safe here. You have a right to be here. You will not be harmed, and we will not hold you against your will. Rest now. We can speak more when you are ready."

Step 4: Non-aggression and Security Check

As a matter of mutual safety and in accordance with the Duty to Ensure Personal Physical Security (Codex of Responsibility, Tier 2.0), the Welcomers will ask if the Seeker is carrying any weapons.

- If so, they will be asked to temporarily entrust them to the care of the **Justicars' Pursuit**, who will secure them in a lockbox. It will be explained that this is a standard, non-negotiable procedure for the safety of all, and the items will be returned upon their departure.
- A Seeker may petition the Council for special permission to carry a weapon brought from outside. This requires a psychological evaluation by the **Tranquil Mind Guild** and a majority vote by the Council to assess any potential risk. If approved, the Seeker is expected to contribute to community defense as a member of a relevant Guild (e.g., Rangers' & Wardens', Ironvine Academy).

Phase 2: The Grace Period & Sharing of Stories

Objective: To build trust, understand the Seeker's situation, and clearly explain the community's core principles and structures.

Step 1: The Invitation to Speak

After the Seeker has rested (no less than 24 hours), two Welcomers will meet with them again. This is not an interrogation but an invitation. They will invite the Seeker to share their story: where they have come from, why they are seeking refuge, and what they need. The Welcomers will listen with empathy and without judgment.

Step 2: The Sharing of the Pact

The Welcomers will then clearly and simply explain the community's core agreements as outlined in the Concord of Guilds and Clan Charters:

- **The Principle of Non-Violence:** "We do not cause physical harm to one another, to guests, or to the land."
- **The Principle of Contribution (The Acorn Economy):** "Our community thrives when everyone contributes to its well-being. We have a system called the Acorn Economy where acts of service, creativity, and care generate value for everyone."

All who are able are expected to contribute in some way."

- **The Principle of Respect & The Two Spheres:** "We respect the dignity, property, and autonomy of all members. We recognize a **Communal Sphere**, where we all have duties to the community's health, and a **Sovereign Sphere**, which protects your personal beliefs and choices."

Step 3: Granting Temporary Asylum (30 Days)

Provided the Seeker agrees in good faith to abide by these core principles, they are formally granted Temporary Asylum for 30 days.

- **Provisioning:** They will be provided with secure lodging, continued access to food, and basic necessities through the Hearth & Hospitality Guild.
- **Guild Sponsorship:** They will be introduced to a community "Sponsor," a volunteer from a relevant Guild (e.g., Civic Stewards, Hearth & Hospitality) who can help them navigate community life, answer questions, and facilitate introductions to the various Guilds.

Phase 3: Integration & Economic Empowerment

Objective: To determine, with the Seeker, their long-term path while providing a dignified way to participate in the Acorn Economy.

Step 1: The Month of Observation & Provisional Contribution

During the 30-day period, the Seeker is encouraged to participate in community life. This is a period of mutual observation.

- **Provisional Contributor Status:** The Seeker is immediately granted "Provisional Contributor" status. They can take on posted tasks on Guild Request Boards appropriate for an Initiate (D-Class).
- **Earning Ren:** For completed tasks, they will be compensated in **Ren**, our local currency, allowing them to acquire goods from the Community Storehouse and participate in the local economy.
- **Generating Love Units (LUs):** Their contributions will be tracked and will generate **Love Units (LUs)** for the community in the relevant categories (e.g., Ecological Health, Mutual Aid), contributing to the Gross Domestic Well-being (GDW). This immediately validates their positive impact.

Step 2: The Council of Choice (Day 25-30)

Towards the end of the 30-day period, the Seeker will be invited to meet with the Provisional Community Council (or its equivalent). The Seeker's Sponsor will attend with them to offer support. The Seeker will be asked to state their intentions. There are three possible outcomes:

- **A) Request for Membership:** If the Seeker wishes to join the community, they may formally request to do so. The Council will consider the request based on the Seeker's demonstrated respect for the community's principles. If accepted, the

Seeker will be guided through the process of formally signing the Clan Charter or equivalent constitutional document and choosing a Guild to join as an Initiate.

- **B) Request for Supported Departure:** If the Seeker wishes to leave, the community has a duty to assist them. This includes returning their entrusted belongings, providing them with provisions (food, water) and a small amount of external currency from the Community Treasury if needed for safe travel, and sharing any knowledge of safe routes. They leave with the community's blessing.
- **C) Request for Extended Asylum:** In special circumstances (e.g., ongoing danger in their place of origin, need for long-term healing), a Seeker may request an extension of their asylum. The Council may grant this on a case-by-case basis, with continued support from the Medical and Hearth & Hospitality Guilds.

Contingency Protocol: Breach of Trust

If, at any point, a Seeker violates a core principle (e.g., commits an act of violence, theft, or serious deception), they will be brought before the Council immediately, with a member of the **Scales of Balance Guild** present to ensure fairness.

- **Restorative Justice Mandate (Codex Tier 4.5):** A restorative justice process, facilitated by the Scales of Balance Guild, will be initiated. The primary goal is to understand the breach, heal the harm caused, and find a path to repair relationships.
- **Revocation of Asylum:** If the harm is severe, or if the Seeker refuses to participate in the restorative process, the Council may vote to revoke their asylum. This action is a last resort, taken only to protect the safety and integrity of the community (in fulfillment of Codex Duty 2.1). The **Justicars' Pursuit** will then escort the Seeker to the edge of the community's lands, provide them with their returned belongings and basic provisions, and instruct them not to return.

Emergency Protocol Integration

As stated in the *Community Resilience Plan (3.1)*, this Universal Refuge Protocol remains in effect even during a community-wide emergency. The Hearth & Hospitality Guilds will manage a safe, separate intake area, the Medical Guilds will provide screenings, and the Scales of Balance Guild will ensure the Seeker's rights are protected at all times. They are to be welcomed as potential assets to our resilience, not treated as a burden.